

LIFE STORY ▼

NOT JUST

VIR DAS's memoir reveals the person behind the smiling mask of a stand-up comic

Comedian-actor and now author Vir Das admits it feels strange to be writing a memoir this early in his career. This reader was surprised, too, given he is in his 40s and is still very active in both industries. The book's release is fitting, as it coincides with Das making his big-screen return, that too in the director's chair with *Happy Patel*, a spy comedy produced by Aamir Khan. The biggest sell for *The Outsider* is that the comic finally opens up on the impact his YouTube special 'Two Indias' had on him emotionally and professionally. Labelled a traitor, he lost shows and eventually had to shut down his com-

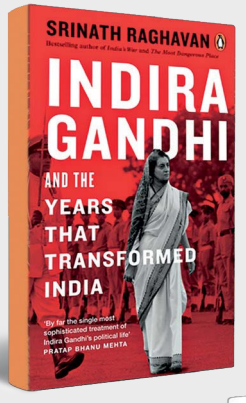
Remembrance of Things Past

AUTHOR AND FORMER AMBASSADOR **T.C.A. RAGHAVAN** ON HIS FAVOURITE MEMOIRS AND BIOGRAPHIES OF 2025

Salima Hashmi's two-volume memoir, *Waiting in the Wings,* and *Enter Stage Left,* is about her father, the great Faiz Ahmed Faiz, and her life. It also illuminates post-1947 Lahore and Pakistan, and is a thoughtful addition to the annals of our always interesting subcontinent.

Gopalkrishna Gandhi's *The Undying Light* stands out for its unusual candour and riveting exploration of the legacy of his grandfathers—C. Rajagopalachari and Mahatma Gandhi. It is also a story of modern India since 1947, and Gandhi's perspective—as a former governor and ambassador, plus a senior aide to more than one President—is a valuable one. Much slimmer and more offbeat is *Rajwati and Her Times,* Madhu Bhaduri's moving memoir of her courageous grandmother's response to Partition's ravages.

Srinath Raghavan's *Indira Gandhi and the Years That Transformed India* provides a valuable perspective



INDIRA GANDHI AND THE YEARS THAT TRANSFORMED INDIA
By Srinath Raghavan
PENGUIN/ALLEN LANE
₹899; 384 pages

THE NEW ICON
Savarkar and the Facts
By Arun Shourie
PENGUIN/VIKING
₹999; 560 pages

